

VandalChat — Scope of Work

University of Idaho · AI chat platform on MindRouter · Prepared **July 31, 2026** · Phase 1 target **August 24, 2026** · Phase 2 Sep 1 – Dec 31, 2026

1. Overview

VandalChat is a self-hosted AI chat platform for the University of Idaho, using MindRouter as its inference backend (FastAPI, React, PostgreSQL, containerized). The baseline platform is already built and running on a beta host. The work is organized in two phases. **Phase 1 (through August 24, 2026)** productionalizes, tests, secures, and operationalizes the existing baseline — no new features are added. **Phase 2 (September 1 – December 31, 2026)** delivers advanced features in incremental releases. The project lead is unavailable August 3–5 and August 12–20; the Phase 1 schedule is arranged so that reviews and beta testing run during those windows, with hands-on work and go-live scheduled around them.

2. Baseline Features (Implemented)

Complete and running on the beta host, verified against live inference. This baseline is the target for the August 24 production launch.

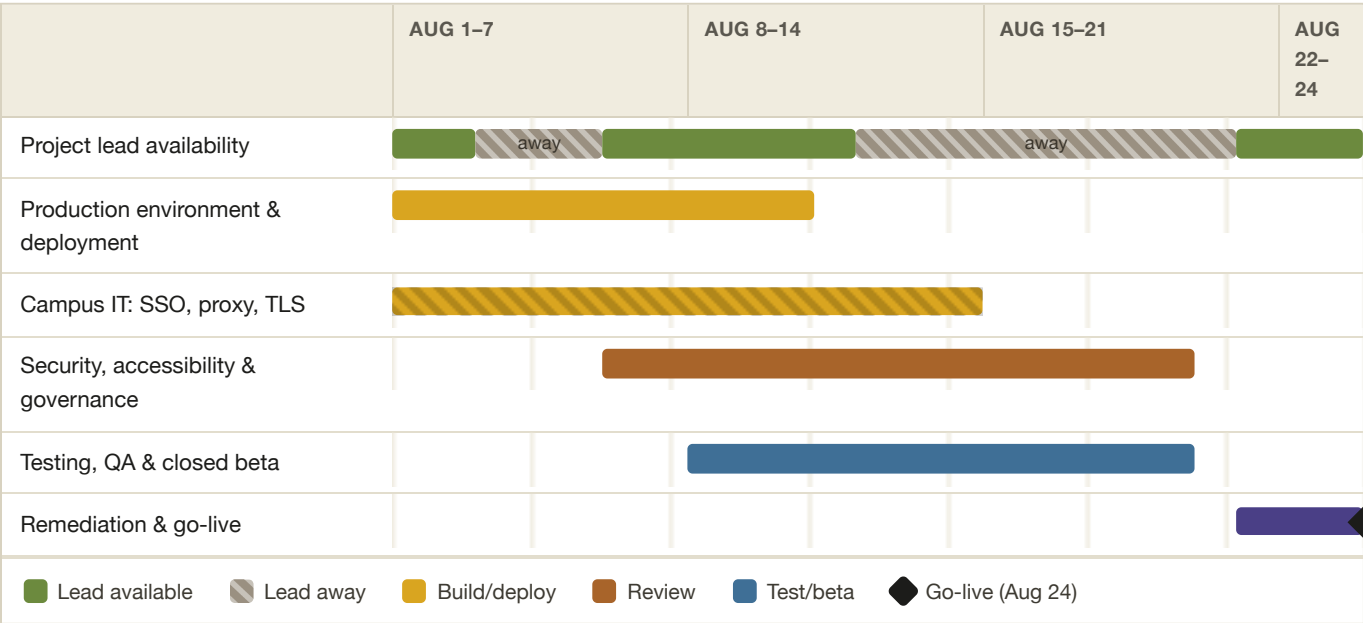
FEATURE AREA	DESCRIPTION
Streaming chat & rendering	Live responses with Markdown, math (KaTeX), code highlighting, music notation, and Mermaid diagrams
Authentication	Azure AD single sign-on and local accounts; user sessions; automatic account provisioning
Conversation history	Saved conversations with automatic titles, pin, rename, search, and delete
Model management	Administrator-curated list of models drawn from MindRouter
Multimodal	Image upload to vision models and image generation
Web search	Automatic and manual web search with cited sources
Voice	Speech-to-text dictation and text-to-speech read-aloud
Document library	Folders, drag-and-drop upload, previews, automatic OCR, per-user storage limits
Document retrieval (RAG)	Embedding and reranking so large document sets can be queried
Tool calling	Built-in tools plus an administrator registry for external (MCP) tool servers
Admin console	Usage analytics, models, users, branding, tools, and feature settings

FEATURE AREA	DESCRIPTION
Branding & theming	University of Idaho identity with light and dark modes
Deployment	Docker Compose and Kubernetes packaging; live beta deployment

3. Phase 1 — Productionalization & Launch (through Aug 24)

Phase 1 takes the completed baseline and makes it production-ready. No new features are built. The focus is production deployment, testing, security and compliance review, and operational readiness.

TASK	DATES	NOTES
Production environment & deployment	Aug 1 – 11	Production host, containers, database, backups, monitoring
Campus IT: SSO, proxy, TLS	Aug 1 – 15	Production single sign-on and reverse proxy / TLS
Security, accessibility & data governance	Aug 6 – 20	Expedited reviews; run during lead absence
Testing, QA & closed beta	Aug 8 – 20	Functional and load testing; limited user group
Remediation & production go-live	Aug 21 – 24	Address findings; deploy to production



4. Deployment

Production deployment tasks within Phase 1.

- **Production host and containers** — deploy the Docker Compose stack (or Kubernetes manifests) on a production host with adequate CPU, memory, and disk.
- **Database** — PostgreSQL with the pgvector extension; scheduled backups of the database and the uploads volume.
- **Inference** — production MindRouter service key with sufficient quota for the expected number of concurrent users.
- **Authentication** — production Azure AD configuration and redirect URI; local administrator account.
- **Reverse proxy and TLS** — campus proxy configured for HTTPS, large file uploads, and streaming responses.
- **Monitoring** — usage analytics and telemetry in the admin console; log review during rollout.

5. Phase 2 — Advanced Features (Sep 1 – Dec 31)

Advanced features delivered as incremental releases after the production launch.

FEATURE	DESCRIPTION	TARGET
User memory	Per-user preferences remembered across conversations	September
Conversation sharing	Share a conversation with other authorized users	September
Prompt caching & controls	Response-length limits and caching for efficiency	September
Custom assistants	Saved assistants with their own instructions and model	October
MCP identity & campus connectors	Tools acting as the signed-in user (Canvas, Microsoft 365, Banner); requires IT data-access approval	Oct – Nov
Sandboxed code execution	Runs code and generates Office files in isolation; requires isolation infrastructure	November
Speech-to-speech voice	Live spoken conversation; requires a real-time MindRouter endpoint	December

	SEPTEMBER	OCTOBER	NOVEMBER	DECEMBER
User memory				
Conversation sharing				
Prompt caching & controls				
Custom assistants				
MCP identity & campus connectors				
Sandboxed code execution				

6. Assumptions and Dependencies

- Project lead is unavailable August 3–5 and August 12–20; reviews and beta testing are scheduled to run during those periods, with remediation and go-live on return (August 21–24).
- No new features are added in Phase 1; scope is limited to productionalizing the existing baseline.
- MindRouter remains available with quota sufficient for the expected concurrent users.
- Campus IT provides production single sign-on configuration and the reverse proxy / TLS in time for the schedule.
- Security, accessibility, and data-governance reviews are expedited to fit the timeline rather than run as full external audits.
- A production host with adequate disk and capacity is available; the current beta host is storage-constrained.
- Personal API keys are provided by MindRouter and are out of scope. Managed fine-tuning is out of scope (insufficient capacity).